

## MRR DISTRIBUTION



Median MRR

\$280

Total Annual Revenue

\$134M

# TrustMRR

## 1,000 Startups, One Uncomfortable Distribution

A revenue-verified directory of mostly tiny software businesses—  
and a handful of giants.



# 1,000

Startup Companies



# \$280

Typical Monthly MRR



# \$134M

Estimated Annual Revenue

TOTAL LISTINGS

1,000

MRR CONCENTRATION

Top 1% 50.6%

## DATASET SNAPSHOT



1,000 startup listings ×  
29 structured variables



Revenue verified through  
Stripe, RevenueCat, Paddle,  
and seven additional  
payment-provider APIs



Snapshot frozen on  
**30 July 2026**  
Single point in time.  
No historical trends.



Typical company: \$280/month  
Largest company: \$3.6M/month



## INTERPRETATION NOTE

This is a self-listed directory—not a market survey. Participation was voluntary, founders chose what to disclose, unsuccessful companies are absent, and many larger private firms are not represented. Interpret every insight as describing “startups that chose to be counted,” rather than the entire SaaS ecosystem.

# The Top 1% Earn More Than the Other 99% Combined

Averages are meaningless here. Use medians.



One coloured square controls *half the money*.

## The Average Trap



Average Annual Revenue

**\$133,750**

Dominated by extreme outliers.

**44×**

Difference



Median Annual Revenue

**\$3,050**

Represents the typical startup.

The average describes *Stan*—not startups.



Top 1%

50.6%



Top 5%

72.9%



Top 10%

84.7%



Top 20%

95.0%



Bottom 80%

5.0%

## The Outlier

Stan

**\$25.0M**

Annual Revenue

18.7% of the Entire Dataset

One company alone accounts for nearly one-fifth of all reported revenue.

## Market Concentration

Gini Coefficient

**0.91**

More concentrated than the income inequality of any country.



8 of the Top 10 companies are US-based



10 of the Top 10 use Stripe



6 of the Top 10 operate as B2B businesses

# One in Five Earns Nothing At All

This is a directory of side projects with a few real companies in it.

## Zero-Revenue Companies



Made \$0 in Last 30 Days

**216**

**21.6%**  
of the Dataset



\$0 Monthly  
Recurring Revenue

**197**

**19.7%**  
of the Dataset



\$0 Over  
Last 12 Months

**109**

**10.9%**  
of the Dataset

## Monthly Recurring Revenue (MRR) Distribution

Logarithmic Scale



## Typical Startup (Median)



Monthly  
Recurring Revenue

**\$280**



12-Month  
Revenue

**\$3,050**



All-Time  
Revenue

**\$3,581**



Active Paying  
Subscribers

**16**

“ The median startup has only **16** paying subscribers.

This—not the **billion-dollar headline**—is the true centre of the TrustMRR dataset. ”



## Why This Matters

Slide 2 revealed the giants.  
Slide 3 reveals the floor.

Together they explain why every  
insight in the rest of this presentation  
uses the **median**—not the **average**.



DATA POINTS  
**29,000**



COMPANIES ANALYZED  
**1,000**



REVENUE VERIFIED  
**100%**



SNAPSHOT DATE  
**30 July 2026**

# Selling to Businesses Pays 5.7× Better

The most popular choice is the least profitable one.



| Revenue by Customer Type |           |            |                         |
|--------------------------|-----------|------------|-------------------------|
| Customer Type            | Companies | Median MRR | Median 12-Month Revenue |
| B2B                      | 255       | \$1,036    | \$8,362                 |
| Both                     | 56        | \$351      | \$3,502                 |
| Not Stated               | 288       | \$194      | \$1,783                 |
| B2C                      | 401       | \$181      | \$2,213                 |

**B2C attracts the most founders—**  
**but delivers the *weakest* median revenue.**

**401** companies (40% of the dataset)  
yet earn less than **one-fifth** of B2B businesses.

### Zero-MRR Comparison

|                                                     |                                                     |
|-----------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| <b>B2B</b><br>27 of 255<br><b>10.6%</b><br>Zero MRR | <b>B2C</b><br>60 of 401<br><b>15.0%</b><br>Zero MRR |
|-----------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|

Business-focused startups fail to monetize less frequently.



## Key Interpretation

This is the first major monetization lever uncovered in the dataset.  
The next slide independently validates the same conclusion using a **completely different dimension**—company category.

# Sales-Led Beats Self-Serve 3.6x

A second, independent column tells exactly the same story as Slide 4.



## Pricing Models

| Pricing Model              | Companies | Median MRR | Median 12-Month Revenue |
|----------------------------|-----------|------------|-------------------------|
| Contact Sales / Enterprise | 48        | \$1,541    | \$13,734                |
| Free Trial → Paid          | 47        | \$807      | \$7,129                 |
| Subscription               | 282       | \$427      | \$3,069                 |
| Free                       | 58        | \$420      | \$4,902                 |
| Other / Unclear            | 84        | \$248      | \$3,236                 |
| In-App Purchase            | 77        | \$169      | \$1,188                 |
| One-Time / Lifetime        | 54        | \$94       | \$1,760                 |
| Freemium                   | 7         | \$47       | \$363                   |
| Not Stated                 | 343       | \$306      | \$4,099                 |



## Zero-MRR Comparison



Business-focused startups fail to monetize less frequently.

“ Two completely independent measurements point to exactly the same conclusion.

Slide 4: Who you sell to.

Slide 5: How you charge.

”

\*Both identify the same monetization pattern: businesses that sell through **higher-touch, recurring revenue** models consistently outperform consumer-oriented self-serve businesses.



## Interpretation

This is the strongest evidence in the entire analysis. Two unrelated variables independently reinforce the same strategic finding, making coincidence significantly less likely.

# The Crowded Categories Are the Poor Ones

Where everyone is competing, nobody is earning.



AI

197 Companies

Largest Category

Only 4th Highest Revenue

Productivity

49 Companies

4th Most Crowded

Only \$42 Median MRR

Top Three Categories

Average 36 Companies

Yet the Highest Median Revenue

“ The busiest markets are not necessarily the most profitable. ”

The highest-earning categories average just 36 companies each, while the largest category—AI—contains nearly one in every five startups yet ranks only fourth in earnings.

| Category Performance |           |            |
|----------------------|-----------|------------|
| Category             | Companies | Median MRR |
| Education            | 30        | \$2,142    |
| Marketing            | 42        | \$1,586    |
| Content Creation     | 36        | \$1,254    |
| AI                   | 197       | \$446      |
| Health & Fitness     | 34        | \$392      |
| SaaS                 | 66        | \$303      |
| Mobile Apps          | 52        | \$223      |
| Dev Tools            | 37        | \$185      |
| E-Commerce           | 19        | \$155      |
| Productivity         | 49        | \$42       |

**Interpret with Care**

Each company is assigned only one primary category, while 274 companies have no category recorded. A separate multi-tag system identifies 437 companies operating in SaaS versus only 66 classified as SaaS. This ranking should therefore be interpreted as indicative—not definitive.

GLOBAL REVENUE FLOW



Total Annual Revenue  
\$133.8M

COMPANY DISTRIBUTION



Total Companies  
1,000

COUNTRY COVERAGE

759

Companies with country data



MRR OVERVIEW

Median MRR  
\$280



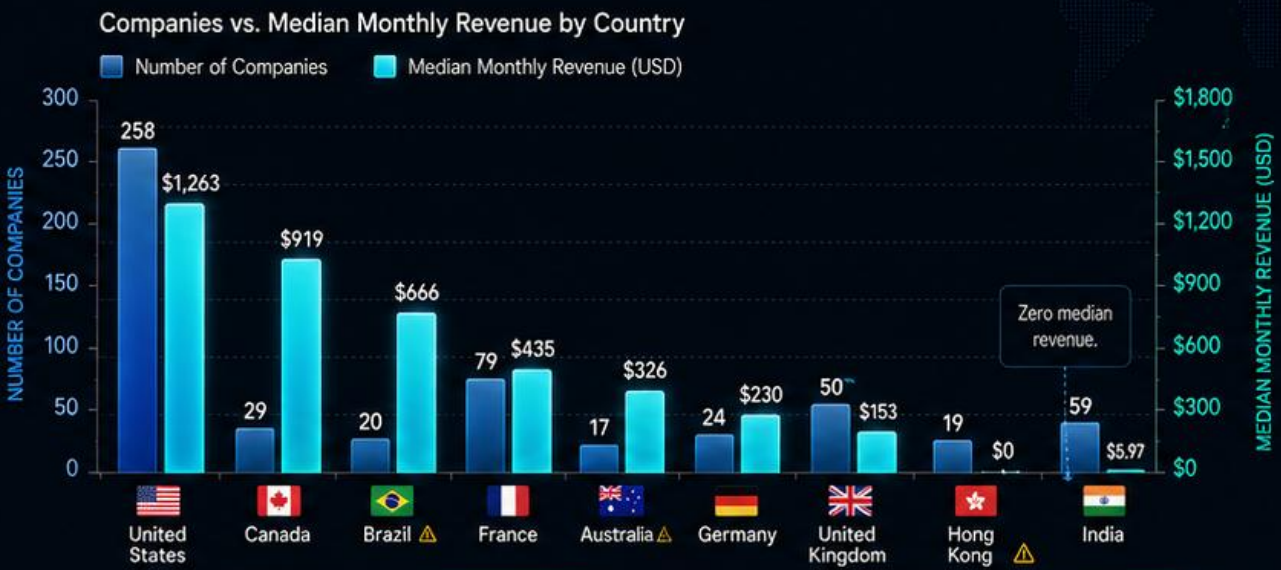
DATA QUALITY

241

Companies with no country data (24.1%)

# A US Startup Earns 211x an Indian One

Company count and earning power are completely decoupled by country.



Median Revenue by Country

| Country        | Companies | Median MRR | Median 12-Month Revenue |
|----------------|-----------|------------|-------------------------|
| United States  | 258       | \$1,263    | \$12,293                |
| Canada         | 29        | \$919      | \$8,165                 |
| Brazil         | 20        | \$666      | \$2,518                 |
| France         | 79        | \$435      | \$4,787                 |
| Australia      | 17        | \$326      | \$2,576                 |
| Germany        | 24        | \$230      | \$502                   |
| United Kingdom | 50        | \$153      | \$1,125                 |
| Hong Kong      | 19        | \$0        | \$773                   |
| India          | 59        | \$5.97     | \$98                    |

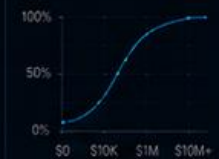
⚠ Fewer than 20 companies. Interpret with caution.

REVENUE HEATMAP



Low High

REVENUE CONCENTRATION



0% 50% 100%

TOP COUNTRY BY REVENUE

United States  
\$85.0M



GLOBAL SCATTER



\$0 \$10K \$100K \$10M \$100M

United States



**\$85.0M**

of

**\$133.8M**

Total Revenue

**63.6%**

Share

India



**59**

Companies

Third Largest Group

Yet

Median MRR

**\$5.97**

Revenue Gap

**211x**

Median US Startup

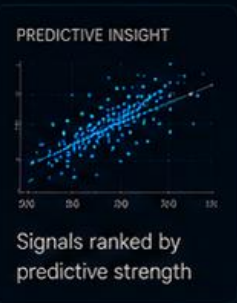
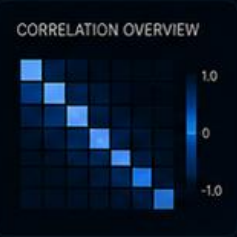
vs

Median Indian Startup

“ Company count **does not** predict earning power. India contributes the **third-largest** number of startups, yet **nearly half** report zero revenue. Meanwhile, the United States generates **almost two-thirds** of the entire dataset’s revenue despite representing only about **one quarter** of all companies. ”

⚠ Interpret Carefully

This reflects participation in an English-language, founder-submitted directory as much as national startup ecosystems. Country information is missing for **241 companies (24.1%)**, which are excluded from this comparison rather than treated as zero.



# Followers Don't Pay the Bills

A website Google trusts beats an audience—and growth rate tells you nothing about company size.

| RELATIONSHIP WITH REVENUE       | STRENGTH (0-1) | VISUAL STRENGTH        | VERDICT                 |
|---------------------------------|----------------|------------------------|-------------------------|
| Subscriber Count → Revenue      | 0.90           | <div><div></div></div> | Internally Consistent   |
| Website Traffic → Revenue       | 0.60           | <div><div></div></div> | Meaningful Relationship |
| Domain Authority → Revenue      | 0.57           | <div><div></div></div> | Owned Channels Matter   |
| X / Twitter Followers → Revenue | 0.21           | <div><div></div></div> | Weak Relationship       |
| Growth Rate → Company Size      | 0.06           | <div><div></div></div> | No Relationship         |

## SUPPORTING EVIDENCE



“ Owned channels **outperform** borrowed audiences. Website authority predicts revenue nearly **three times** better than follower counts, suggesting **durable customer acquisition** matters far more than social popularity. ”

STRATEGIC LESSON 1

**Build Assets, Not Audiences**

Invest in discoverability, SEO, and owned distribution rather than chasing vanity metrics.

STRATEGIC LESSON 2

**Growth Isn't Size**

Within this startup population, larger companies are no more likely to grow than smaller ones.

INTERPRETATION

These relationships describe statistical association only. They do not establish causation and are not adjusted for industry, geography, pricing model, or customer segment.



REVENUE OVERVIEW



Total Annual Revenue  
\$133.8M

DATA COVERAGE



1,000  
Companies Analyzed

DATA QUALITY

241 (24.1%)

Companies with missing country

CORRELATION MATRIX



-1.0 0 1.0

MODEL STRENGTH

R<sup>2</sup>  
0.81



# The Companies Hiding Their Names Are the Winners

Missing data isn't always a defect. Here, it's the most valuable variable in the file.



“ The absence of information is itself information. Concealing a company name and website appears to be a deliberate privacy choice made disproportionately by successful businesses—not evidence of incomplete records. ”

Important Correction

An earlier interpretation classified 'Stealth Company' records as placeholder text requiring cleanup. Further analysis revealed the opposite: they represent the highest-earning segment in the entire dataset.

Why This Isn't Bad Data

Perfect Overlap



129  
Stealth Companies

↓

129  
No Website

Zero Exceptions

Top Performers



35  
of the 129  
appear in  
Top 10%

2.7×

More Than  
Expected

Elite Companies



2  
of the  
Top 10

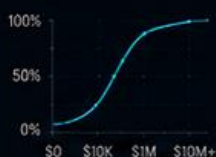
Highest-Revenue  
Companies  
Are Stealth Listings

## ACQUISITION OVERVIEW



Total Companies  
1,000

## REVENUE CONCENTRATION



## DATA COVERAGE



## MEDIAN MRR OVER TIME



## DATA CONFIDENCE



# 262 Companies Are For Sale – At Roughly Double the Advertised Price

The quoted multiple uses a flattering formula. Recalculate before you bid.

## Advertised Valuation

## 2.3×

Revenue Multiple  
Marketplace Listing

## Actual Valuation

## 4.75×

Trailing 12-Month Revenue  
Recalculated

## ≈ 2×

Higher Than  
Advertised

**Advertised Multiple = Asking Price ÷ (Last 30 Days Revenue × 12)**

This assumes the latest month's revenue repeats perfectly for an entire year, making rapidly growing companies appear cheaper than they truly are—and potentially overstating value for businesses with unusually strong recent performance.



Companies Listed  
for Sale

## 262

**26.2%**  
of Dataset



Median Asking Price

## \$35,000

Companies for Sale



Median 12-Month Revenue

## \$7,967

Compared with  
**\$2,416**  
for the Rest of the Dataset

**≈3.3×**  
Higher

## EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

### 01



#### Never Use the Average

Ten companies control half the revenue.  
Use **medians** instead.

### 02



#### Sell to Businesses

B2B businesses earn **5.7×** more than B2C,  
supported independently by pricing strategy.

### 03



#### Avoid Crowded Markets

AI and Productivity attract many founders,  
but generate surprisingly **weak median revenue**.

### 04



#### Own Your Distribution

Strong websites outperform social followings.  
Followers have **little relationship** with revenue.

### 05



#### Always Recalculate Valuations

Ignore advertised multiples.  
Use **trailing twelve-month revenue**  
before pricing an acquisition.

## VALUATION DISTRIBUTION



## MRR SCATTERPLOT



## REVENUE CURVE



“ The biggest **opportunities** in startup investing often appear only after the **averages disappear**. ”

Once the outliers, missing data, pricing mechanics, and self-selection biases are understood, the dataset tells a remarkably consistent story about what actually drives software business success.



## FINAL PERSPECTIVE

This analysis describes an opt-in, revenue-verified founder directory at a single point in time. It identifies consistent associations—not causal relationships—and should be interpreted within the context of self-selection and incomplete disclosure.

